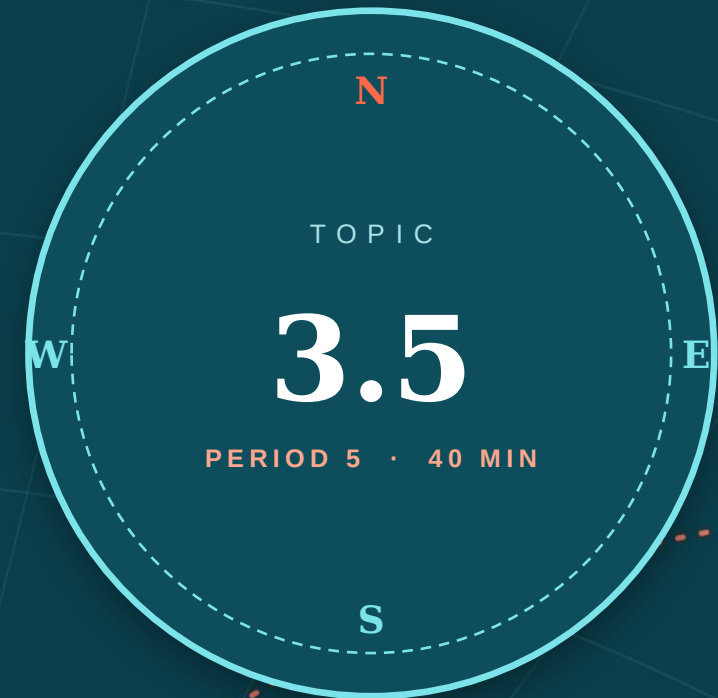


UNIT 3 · TOPIC 3.5

Backhauls and Directional Fares

When going backwards costs you more.

B.B.A. Aviation Management · Semester III · Unit 3: Fare Construction (Advanced)
Air Ticketing & Fare Construction (2ACBAM32) · Arun Kumar



TOPIC 3.5

Expedition Preview: Topic Intro



The graphic is a dark teal rectangular box with rounded corners. At the top left, it says 'UNIT 3 · TOPIC 3.5' in a small white box, followed by 'FARE CONSTRUCTION (ADVANCED)' in a smaller font. The main title 'Backhauls and Directional Fares' is in large, bold, white serif font. Below it is the tagline 'When going backwards costs you more.' in a smaller, italicized white font. To the right of the title is a large white play button icon. Further right is a circular compass rose with a red needle pointing North. The compass has 'N', 'S', 'E', and 'W' labels. In the center of the compass, it says 'TOPIC 3.5'. At the bottom left of the graphic, there is a small white globe icon followed by the text 'AIR TICKETING & FARE CONSTRUCTION · UNIT 3 · TOPIC 3.5'. A dashed red line curves from the bottom right of the compass towards the bottom right corner of the graphic.

UNIT 3 · TOPIC 3.5

FARE CONSTRUCTION (ADVANCED)

Backhauls and Directional Fares

When going backwards costs you more.

AIR TICKETING & FARE CONSTRUCTION · UNIT 3 · TOPIC 3.5

Air Ticketing & Fare Construction · Unit 3: Fare Construction (Advanced) · Topic 3.5

02

TOPIC 3.5

Navigator's Question



THINK ABOUT IT

Why would flying “backwards” on a route cost you extra?

**THINK**

30 seconds alone

**PAIR**

1 minute with a neighbour

**SHARE**

2–3 answers with the class



TOPIC 3.5

Route Map for Today

1

3.5.1

Backhaul fares: pricing for backtracking or flying in the opposite direction

2

3.5.2

Directional fares: how fares differ by direction (e.g., eastbound vs westbound)

3

3.5.3

Impact on pricing

4

3.5.4

How backhaul and directional pricing affect prices and passenger behaviour



COURSE OBJECTIVES

- Define a backhaul and the BHC check
- Explain directional fare differences
- Calculate a simple BHC
- Discuss passenger behaviour and ethics

Pedagogy: Inquiry-Based Learning



TOPIC 3.5.1

What Is a Backhaul?

**Travelling backwards**

Routing goes past the destination direction and returns.

**Undercharging risk**

The through fare may be less than the fare to an intermediate point.

**BHC check**

Backhaul Check protects the fare on one-way journeys.

**BHC RULE**

For a one-way journey, if the fare from origin to an intermediate stopover point is higher than the through fare, the difference must be added.



TOPIC 3.5.1

BHC Worked Example

One-way BOM–LON–DXB with stopover in London.

- Through fare: BOM–DXB.
- Highest intermediate fare: BOM–LON.
- BOM–LON is higher than BOM–DXB.
- Add the difference (BHC).



BACKHAUL CHECK (illustrative)

```
THROUGH FARE BOM-DXB    NUC 300
```

```
BOM-LON (INTERMEDIATE) NUC 650
```

```
BHC  650 - 300 =    NUC 350
```

```
FARE = 300 + 350 = NUC 650
```

```
// fares invented
```

TOPIC 3.5.2

Directional Fares: East vs West



Eastbound from India

- DEL–SIN–SYD fares
- Filed from India market
- Reflect Indian demand and ROE

vs



Westbound from Australia

- SYD–SIN–DEL fares
- Filed from Australian market
- Can be very different price

TOPIC 3.5.3

Impact on Pricing



Extra Charges

BHC adds amounts when routings backtrack.



Routing Choice

Airlines may block fares via backtracking points.



Origin Matters

Start the ticket in a cheaper market = different price.



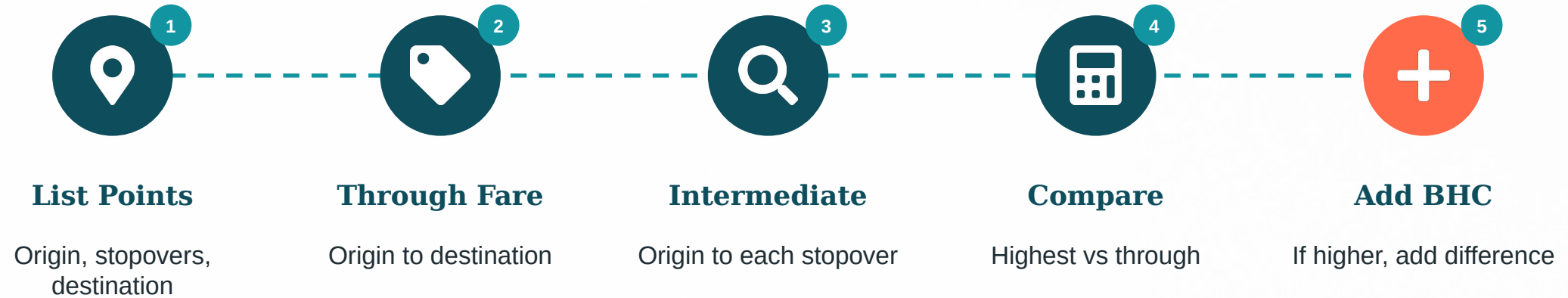
Fairness

Rules stop underpricing of long journeys.



TOPIC 3.5.3

Checking for Backhaul



TOPIC 3.5.4

Passenger Behaviour



Price Shopping

Travellers compare origins and routings to save money.



Hidden-City Ticketing

Booking A–C via B and leaving at B — breaks fare rules; airlines may cancel onward/return.



Throwaway Ticketing

Buying a return and using one way — also restricted.

TOPIC 3.5.4

Inquiry: Is It Fair?

**Question 1**

Why do airlines price backhauls higher?

**Question 2**

Is hidden-city ticketing unethical or just smart?

**Question 3**

What should an agent advise?

**AGENT POSITION**

Agents must price correctly and never advise rule-breaking. Explain legitimate options: different dates, carriers or routings.



TOPIC 3.5.4

Directional Difference (Illustrative)

NUC 780

DEL–SYD one-way (from India)

NUC 950

SYD–DEL one-way (from Australia)

22%

difference due to direction and market

TOPIC 3.5

Navigation Exercise: Route Investigators



PEDAGOGY

Inquiry-Based Learning

TIME · 12 min

FORMAT · Groups of 3

1

Research one route's fare in both directions on the same airline.

2

Record and compare the prices in INR.

3

Map a backhaul itinerary and apply the BHC with given fares.

4

Present: what explains the difference?



TOPIC 3.5

[Click to reveal each answer](#)

Position Check Quiz

Q1**BHC is applied mainly to...**

- A) Round trips
- B) One-way journeys
- C) Group fares
- D) Infant fares

ANSWER

B**Q2****Through fare NUC 300; intermediate fare NUC 450. BHC =**

- A) 0
- B) 150
- C) 300
- D) 750

ANSWER

B**Q3****Leaving a journey at the connection point to save money is...**

- A) Stopover
- B) Hidden-city ticketing
- C) Codeshare
- D) Open-jaw

ANSWER

B**Q4****Directional fares mean price depends on...**

- A) Direction of travel
- B) Seat colour
- C) Aircraft type
- D) Crew

ANSWER

A

DESTINATION REACHED

Key Takeaways

- ✓ Backhaul = routing back past the direction of travel
- ✓ BHC adds the difference if an intermediate fare is higher
- ✓ Fares are directional — origin market matters
- ✓ Hidden-city and throwaway ticketing breach fare rules

EXIT TICKET Write 1 thing you learned today + 1 question you still have.

NEXT WAYPOINT

Topic 3.6 — Stopovers and Layovers

Thank you · Questions?